

AI Capability Boundary Reference

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

KNOW THE BOUNDARY
— *before you delegate*

Know what the tool does well and where it systematically fails before you delegate. Organized by task type, not technical architecture. Each entry connects to Module 3's mechanical framework.

● WHERE AI IS RELIABLE

Tasks where models produce useful output under well-specified prompts. Reliability here means errors are infrequent rather than absent.

TASK TYPE	WHY IT WORKS	NOTES
Drafting and composition	Dense training patterns for written formats (emails, memos, reports). Well-specified prompts produce well-structured output.	Quality scales with Description quality. Specify product, process, and performance.
Summarizing and compression	The model excels at identifying high-probability patterns, which is what compression requires.	Verify completeness; the model may drop low-frequency details.
Reformatting and restructuring	Deterministic tasks with clear output specifications. Token-level manipulation within well-defined patterns.	Format + audience + length spec → reliable output.
Brainstorming and ideation	High-temperature sampling across the probability distribution produces diverse options by design.	Useful for breadth. Evaluate each option independently; plausible ≠ good.
Translation (major languages)	Dense training representation for high-resource language pairs (English ↔ Spanish, French, German, Mandarin).	Reliability drops for lower-resource languages due to tokenization asymmetry. See page 2.
Code generation (common patterns)	Well-documented languages and frameworks are heavily represented in training data.	Edge cases, niche libraries, and novel architectures are less reliable. Test all output.
Pattern recognition in text	Categorization, sentiment analysis, entity extraction: tasks where the model identifies structure.	Reliable for well-defined categories. Less reliable for subjective or culturally specific judgments.